

Chapter 22

Vector Algebra

Only One Option Correct Type Questions

1. The number of distinct real values of λ , for the vector $-\lambda^2\hat{i} + \hat{j} + \hat{k}$, $\hat{i} - \lambda^2\hat{j} + \hat{k}$ and $\hat{i} + \hat{j} - \lambda^2\hat{k}$ are coplanar, is
[IIT-JEE-2007 (Paper-1)]
(A) Zero (B) One
(C) Two (D) Three
2. Let $\vec{a}, \vec{b}, \vec{c}$ be unit vectors such that $\vec{a} + \vec{b} + \vec{c} = 0$. Which one of the following is correct?
[IIT-JEE-2007 (Paper-2)]
(A) $\vec{a} \times \vec{b} = \vec{b} \times \vec{c} = \vec{c} \times \vec{a} = 0$ (B) $\vec{a} \times \vec{b} = \vec{b} \times \vec{c} = \vec{c} \times \vec{a} \neq 0$
(C) $\vec{a} \times \vec{b} = \vec{b} \times \vec{c} = \vec{a} \times \vec{c} \neq 0$ (D) $\vec{a} \times \vec{b}, \vec{b} \times \vec{c}, \vec{c} \times \vec{a}$ are mutually perpendicular
3. The edges of a parallelepiped are of unit length and are parallel to non-coplanar unit vectors $\hat{a}, \hat{b}, \hat{c}$ such that
 $\hat{a} \cdot \hat{b} = \hat{b} \cdot \hat{c} = \hat{c} \cdot \hat{a} = \frac{1}{2}$
Then, the volume of the parallelepiped is
[IIT-JEE-2008 (Paper-1)]
(A) $\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$ (B) $\frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}}$
(C) $\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$ (D) $\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$
4. Let two non-collinear unit vectors $\hat{a}$ and $\hat{b}$ form an acute angle. A point P moves so that at any time t the position vector $\vec{OP}$ (where O is the origin) is given by $\hat{a} \cos t + \hat{b} \sin t$. When P is farthest from origin O , let M be the length of $\vec{OP}$ and $\hat{u}$ be the unit vector along $\vec{OP}$. Then,
[IIT-JEE-2008 (Paper-2)]
(A) $\hat{u} = \frac{\hat{a} + \hat{b}}{|\hat{a} + \hat{b}|}$ and $M = (1 + \hat{a} \cdot \hat{b})^{\frac{1}{2}}$ (B) $\hat{u} = \frac{\hat{a} - \hat{b}}{|\hat{a} - \hat{b}|}$ and $M = (1 + \hat{a} \cdot \hat{b})^{\frac{1}{2}}$
(C) $\hat{u} = \frac{\hat{a} + \hat{b}}{|\hat{a} + \hat{b}|}$ and $M = (1 + 2\hat{a} \cdot \hat{b})^{\frac{1}{2}}$ (D) $\hat{u} = \frac{\hat{a} - \hat{b}}{|\hat{a} - \hat{b}|}$ and $M = (1 + 2\hat{a} \cdot \hat{b})^{\frac{1}{2}}$
5. Let $P(3, 2, 6)$ be a point in space and Q be a point on the line $\vec{r} = (\hat{i} - \hat{j} + 2\hat{k}) + \mu(-3\hat{i} + \hat{j} + 5\hat{k})$. Then the value of μ for which the vector $\vec{PQ}$ is parallel to the plane $x - 4y + 3z = 1$ is
[IIT-JEE-2009 (Paper-1)]
(A) $\frac{1}{4}$ (B) $-\frac{1}{4}$
(C) $\frac{1}{8}$ (D) $-\frac{1}{8}$

6. If $\vec{a}, \vec{b}, \vec{c}$ and $\vec{d}$ are unit vectors such that $(\vec{a} \times \vec{b}) \cdot (\vec{c} \times \vec{d}) = 1$ and $\vec{a} \cdot \vec{c} = \frac{1}{2}$, then

[IIT-JEE-2009 (Paper-1)]

- (A) $\vec{a}, \vec{b}, \vec{c}$ are non-coplanar (B) $\vec{b}, \vec{c}, \vec{d}$ are non-coplanar
(C) $\vec{b}, \vec{d}$ are non-parallel (D) $\vec{a}, \vec{d}$ are parallel and $\vec{b}, \vec{c}$ are parallel

7. Let P, Q, R and S be the points on the plane with position vectors $-2\hat{i} - \hat{j}$, $4\hat{i}$, $3\hat{i} + 3\hat{j}$ and $-3\hat{i} + 2\hat{j}$ respectively. The quadrilateral $PQRS$ must be a

[IIT-JEE-2010 (Paper-1)]

- (A) Parallelogram, which is neither a rhombus nor a rectangle
(B) Square
(C) Rectangle, but not a square
(D) Rhombus, but not a square

8. Two adjacent sides of a parallelogram $ABCD$ are given by $\vec{AB} = 2\hat{i} + 10\hat{j} + 11\hat{k}$ and $\vec{AD} = -\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + 2\hat{k}$. The side AD is rotated by an acute angle α in the plane of the parallelogram so that AD becomes AD' . If AD' makes a right angle with the side AB , then the cosine of the angle α is given by

[IIT-JEE-2010 (Paper-2)]

- (A) $\frac{8}{9}$ (B) $\frac{\sqrt{17}}{9}$
(C) $\frac{1}{9}$ (D) $\frac{4\sqrt{5}}{9}$

9. Let $\vec{a} = \hat{i} + \hat{j} + \hat{k}$, $\vec{b} = \hat{i} - \hat{j} + \hat{k}$ and $\vec{c} = \hat{i} - \hat{j} - \hat{k}$ be three vectors. A vector $\vec{v}$ in the plane of $\vec{a}$ and $\vec{b}$, whose projection on $\vec{c}$ is $\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$, is given by

[IIT-JEE-2011 (Paper-1)]

- (A) $\hat{i} - 3\hat{j} + 3\hat{k}$ (B) $-3\hat{i} - 3\hat{j} - \hat{k}$
(C) $3\hat{i} - \hat{j} + 3\hat{k}$ (D) $\hat{i} + 3\hat{j} - 3\hat{k}$

10. If $\vec{a}$ and $\vec{b}$ are vectors such that $|\vec{a} + \vec{b}| = \sqrt{29}$ and $\vec{a} \times (2\hat{i} + 3\hat{j} + 4\hat{k}) = (2\hat{i} + 3\hat{j} + 4\hat{k}) \times \vec{b}$, then a possible value of $(\vec{a} + \vec{b}) \cdot (-7\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + 3\hat{k})$ is

[IIT-JEE-2012 (Paper-2)]

- (A) 0 (B) 3
(C) 4 (D) 8

11. Let $\vec{PR} = 3\hat{i} + \hat{j} - 2\hat{k}$ and $\vec{SQ} = \hat{i} - 3\hat{j} - 4\hat{k}$ determine diagonals of a parallelogram $PQRS$ and $\vec{PT} = \hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + 3\hat{k}$ be another vector. Then the volume of the parallelepiped determined by the vectors $\vec{PT}, \vec{PQ}$ and $\vec{PS}$ is

[JEE (Adv)-2013 (Paper-1)]

- (A) 5 (B) 20
(C) 10 (D) 30

12. Let O be the origin and let PQR be an arbitrary triangle. The point S is such that

$$\overrightarrow{OP} \cdot \overrightarrow{OQ} + \overrightarrow{OR} \cdot \overrightarrow{OS} = \overrightarrow{OR} \cdot \overrightarrow{OP} + \overrightarrow{OQ} \cdot \overrightarrow{OS} = \overrightarrow{OQ} \cdot \overrightarrow{OR} + \overrightarrow{OP} \cdot \overrightarrow{OS}$$

Then the triangle PQR has S as its

[JEE (Adv)-2017 (Paper-2)]

- (A) Incentre (B) Circumcentre
(C) Orthocenter (D) Centroid

One or More Option(s) Correct Type Questions

13. The vector(s) which is/are coplanar with vectors $\hat{i} + \hat{j} + 2\hat{k}$ and $\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + \hat{k}$, and perpendicular to the vector $\hat{i} + \hat{j} + \hat{k}$ is/are

[IIT-JEE-2011 (Paper-1)]

- (A) $\hat{j} - \hat{k}$ (B) $-\hat{j} + \hat{k}$
(C) $\hat{i} - \hat{j}$ (D) $-\hat{j} + \hat{k}$

14. Let $\vec{x}$, $\vec{y}$ and $\vec{z}$ be three vectors each of magnitude $\sqrt{2}$ and the angle between each pair of them is $\frac{\pi}{3}$. If $\vec{a}$ is a nonzero vector perpendicular to $\vec{x}$ and $\vec{y} \times \vec{z}$ and $\vec{b}$ is a nonzero vector perpendicular to $\vec{y}$ and $\vec{z} \times \vec{x}$, then

[JEE (Adv)-2014 (Paper-1)]

- (A) $\vec{b} = (\vec{b} \cdot \vec{z})(\vec{z} - \vec{x})$ (B) $\vec{a} = (\vec{a} \cdot \vec{y})(\vec{y} - \vec{z})$
(C) $\vec{a} \cdot \vec{b} = -(\vec{a} \cdot \vec{y})(\vec{b} \cdot \vec{z})$ (D) $\vec{a} = (\vec{a} \cdot \vec{y})(\vec{z} - \vec{y})$

15. Let ΔPQR be a triangle. Let $\vec{a} = \overrightarrow{QR}$, $\vec{b} = \overrightarrow{RP}$ and $\vec{c} = \overrightarrow{PQ}$. If $|\vec{a}| = 12$, $|\vec{b}| = 4\sqrt{3}$ and $\vec{b} \cdot \vec{c} = 24$, then which of the following is (are) true?

[JEE (Adv)-2015 (Paper-1)]

- (A) $\frac{|\vec{c}|^2}{2} - |\vec{a}| = 12$ (B) $\frac{|\vec{c}|^2}{2} + |\vec{a}| = 30$
(C) $|\vec{a} \times \vec{b} + \vec{c} \times \vec{a}| = 48\sqrt{3}$ (D) $\vec{a} \cdot \vec{b} = -72$

16. Let $\hat{u} = u_1\hat{i} + u_2\hat{j} + u_3\hat{k}$ be a unit vector in $\mathbb{R}^3$ and $\hat{w} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{6}}(\hat{i} + \hat{j} + 2\hat{k})$. Given that there exists a vector $\vec{v}$ in $\mathbb{R}^3$ such that $|\hat{u} \times \vec{v}| = 1$ and $\hat{w} \cdot (\hat{u} \times \vec{v}) = 1$. Which of the following statement(s) is(are) correct?

[JEE (Adv)-2016 (Paper-2)]

- (A) There is exactly one choice for such $\vec{v}$ (B) There are infinitely many choices for such $\vec{v}$
(C) If $\hat{u}$ lies in the xy -plane, then $|u_1| = |u_2|$ (D) If $\hat{u}$ lies in the xz -plane, then $2|u_1| = |u_3|$

17. Let L_1 and L_2 denote the lines $\vec{r} = \hat{i} + \lambda(-\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + 2\hat{k})$, $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\vec{r} = \mu(2\hat{i} - \hat{j} + 2\hat{k})$, $\mu \in \mathbb{R}$ respectively. If L_3 is a line which is perpendicular to both L_1 and L_2 and cuts both of them, then which of the following options describe(s) L_3 ?

[JEE (Adv)-2019 (Paper-1)]

- (A) $\vec{r} = \frac{1}{3}(2\hat{i} + \hat{k}) + t(2\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} - \hat{k})$, $t \in \mathbb{R}$ (B) $\vec{r} = \frac{2}{9}(4\hat{i} + \hat{j} + \hat{k}) + t(2\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} - \hat{k})$, $t \in \mathbb{R}$
(C) $\vec{r} = \frac{2}{9}(2\hat{i} - \hat{j} + 2\hat{k}) + t(2\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} - \hat{k})$, $t \in \mathbb{R}$ (D) $\vec{r} = t(2\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} - \hat{k})$, $t \in \mathbb{R}$

18. Three lines

$$L_1: \quad \vec{r} = \lambda \hat{i}, \lambda \in \mathbb{R},$$

$$L_2: \quad \vec{r} = \hat{k} + \mu \hat{j}, \mu \in \mathbb{R} \text{ and}$$

$$L_3: \quad \vec{r} = \hat{i} + \hat{j} + v \hat{k}, v \in \mathbb{R}$$

are given. For which point(s) Q on L_2 can we find a point P on L_1 and a point R on L_3 so that P, Q and R are collinear?

[JEE (Adv)-2019 (Paper-1)]

(A) $\hat{k} + \hat{j}$

(B) $\hat{k}$

(C) $\hat{k} + \frac{1}{2} \hat{j}$

(D) $\hat{k} - \frac{1}{2} \hat{j}$

19. Let a and b be positive real numbers. Suppose $\overrightarrow{PQ} = a\hat{i} + b\hat{j}$ and $\overrightarrow{PS} = a\hat{i} - b\hat{j}$ are adjacent sides of a parallelogram $PQRS$. Let $\vec{u}$ and $\vec{v}$ be the projection vectors of $\overrightarrow{WS} = \hat{i} + \hat{j}$ along $\overrightarrow{PQ}$ and $\overrightarrow{PS}$, respectively.

If $|\vec{u}| + |\vec{v}| = |\overrightarrow{WS}|$ and if the area of the parallelogram $PQRS$ is 8, then which of the following statements is/are TRUE?

[JEE (Adv)-2020 (Paper-2)]

(A) $a + b = 4$

(B) $a - b = 2$

(C) The length of the diagonal PR of the parallelogram $PQRS$ is 4

(D) $\overrightarrow{WS}$ is an angle bisector of the vectors $\overrightarrow{PQ}$ and $\overrightarrow{PS}$

20. Let O be the origin and $\overrightarrow{OA} = 2\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + \hat{k}$, $\overrightarrow{OB} = \hat{i} - 2\hat{j} + 2\hat{k}$ and $\overrightarrow{OC} = \frac{1}{2}(\overrightarrow{OB} - \lambda \overrightarrow{OA})$ for some $\lambda > 0$.

If $|\overrightarrow{OB} \times \overrightarrow{OC}| = \frac{9}{2}$, then which of the following statements is (are) TRUE ?

[JEE (Adv)-2021 (Paper-2)]

(A) Projection of $\overrightarrow{OC}$ on $\overrightarrow{OA}$ is $-\frac{3}{2}$

(B) Area of the triangle OAB is $\frac{9}{2}$

(C) Area of the triangle ABC is $\frac{9}{2}$

(D) The acute angle between the diagonals of the parallelogram with adjacent sides $\overrightarrow{OA}$ and $\overrightarrow{OC}$ is $\frac{\pi}{3}$

21. Let $\hat{i}, \hat{j}$ and $\hat{k}$ be the unit vectors along the three positive coordinate axes. Let

$$\vec{a} = 3\hat{i} + \hat{j} - \hat{k},$$

$$\vec{b} = \hat{i} + b_2\hat{j} + b_3\hat{k}, \quad b_2, b_3 \in \mathbb{R},$$

$$\vec{c} = c_1\hat{i} + c_2\hat{j} + c_3\hat{k}, \quad c_1, c_2, c_3 \in \mathbb{R}$$

be three vectors such that $b_2 b_3 > 0$, $\vec{a} \cdot \vec{b} = 0$ and

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & -c_3 & c_2 \\ c_3 & 0 & -c_1 \\ -c_2 & c_1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ b_2 \\ b_3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 - c_1 \\ 1 - c_2 \\ -1 - c_3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then, which of the following is/are TRUE?

[JEE (Adv)-2022 (Paper-2)]

(A) $\vec{a} \cdot \vec{c} = 0$

(B) $\vec{b} \cdot \vec{c} = 0$

(C) $|\vec{b}| > \sqrt{10}$

(D) $|\vec{c}| \leq \sqrt{11}$

Linked Comprehension Type Questions

Paragraph for Q.Nos. 22 and 23

Let O be the origin, and $\vec{OX}$, $\vec{OY}$, $\vec{OZ}$ be three unit vectors in the directions of the sides $\vec{QR}$, $\vec{RP}$, $\vec{PQ}$, respectively, of a triangle PQR .

[JEE (Adv)-2017 (Paper-2)]

Choose the correct answer :

22. $|\vec{OX} \times \vec{OY}| =$

(A) $\sin(P + R)$

(B) $\sin 2R$

(C) $\sin(P + Q)$

(D) $\sin(Q + R)$

23. If the triangle PQR varies, then the minimum value of $\cos(P + Q) + \cos(Q + R) + \cos(R + P)$ is

(A) $-\frac{3}{2}$

(B) $\frac{3}{2}$

(C) $\frac{5}{3}$

(D) $-\frac{5}{3}$

Matrix-Match / Matrix Based Type Questions

24. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists

[JEE (Adv)-2013 (Paper-2)]

List-I

List-II

P. Volume of parallelepiped determined by vectors $\vec{a}, \vec{b}$ and $\vec{c}$ is 2. Then the volume of the parallelepiped determined by vectors $2(\vec{a} \times \vec{b}), 3(\vec{b} \times \vec{c})$ and $(\vec{c} \times \vec{a})$ is

1. 100

Q. Volume of parallelepiped determined by vectors $\vec{a}, \vec{b}$ and $\vec{c}$ is 5. Then the volume of the parallelepiped determined by vectors $3(\vec{a} + \vec{b}), (\vec{b} + \vec{c})$ and $2(\vec{c} + \vec{a})$ is

2. 30

R. Area of a triangle with adjacent sides determined by vectors $\vec{a}$ and $\vec{b}$ is 20. Then the area of the triangle with adjacent sides determined by vectors $(2\vec{a} + 3\vec{b})$ and $(\vec{a} - \vec{b})$ is

3. 24

S. Area of a parallelogram with adjacent sides 4. 60

determined by vectors $\vec{a}$ and $\vec{b}$ is 30.

Then the area of the parallelogram with adjacent sides determined by vectors

$(\vec{a} + \vec{b})$ and $\vec{a}$ is

Codes

P	Q	R	S
(A) 4	2	3	1
(B) 2	3	1	4
(C) 3	4	1	2
(D) 1	4	3	2

Integer / Numerical Value Type Questions

25. If $\vec{a}$ and $\vec{b}$ are vectors in space given by $\vec{a} = \frac{\hat{i} - 2\hat{j}}{\sqrt{5}}$ and $\vec{b} = \frac{2\hat{i} + \hat{j} + 3\hat{k}}{\sqrt{14}}$, then the value of $(2\vec{a} + \vec{b}) \cdot [(\vec{a} \times \vec{b}) \times (\vec{a} - 2\vec{b})]$ is [IIT-JEE-2010 (Paper-1)]
26. Let $\vec{a} = -\hat{i} - \hat{k}$, $\vec{b} = -\hat{i} + \hat{j}$ and $\vec{c} = \hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + 3\hat{k}$ be three given vectors. If $\vec{r}$ is a vector such that $\vec{r} \times \vec{b} = \vec{c} \times \vec{b}$ and $\vec{r} \cdot \vec{a} = 0$, then the value of $\vec{r} \cdot \vec{b}$ is [IIT-JEE-2011 (Paper-2)]
27. If $\vec{a}$, $\vec{b}$ and $\vec{c}$ are unit vectors satisfying $|\vec{a} - \vec{b}|^2 + |\vec{b} - \vec{c}|^2 + |\vec{c} - \vec{a}|^2 = 9$, then $|2\vec{a} + 5\vec{b} + 5\vec{c}|$ is [IIT-JEE-2012 (Paper-1)]
28. Consider the set of eight vectors $V = \{a\hat{i} + b\hat{j} + c\hat{k} : a, b, c \in \{-1, 1\}\}$. Three non-coplanar vectors can be chosen from V in 2^p ways. Then p is [JEE (Adv)-2013 (Paper-1)]
29. Let $\vec{a}$, $\vec{b}$ and $\vec{c}$ be three non-coplanar unit vectors such that the angle between every pair of them is $\frac{\pi}{3}$. If $\vec{a} \times \vec{b} + \vec{b} \times \vec{c} = p\vec{a} + q\vec{b} + r\vec{c}$, where p , q and r are scalars, then the value of $\frac{p^2 + 2q^2 + r^2}{q^2}$ is [JEE (Adv)-2014 (Paper-1)]
30. Let $\vec{a}$ and $\vec{b}$ be two unit vectors such that $\vec{a} \cdot \vec{b} = 0$. For some $x, y \in \mathbb{R}$, let $\vec{c} = x\vec{a} + y\vec{b} + (\vec{a} \times \vec{b})$. If $|\vec{c}| = 2$ and the vector $\vec{c}$ is inclined at the same angle α to both $\vec{a}$ and $\vec{b}$, then the value of $8 \cos^2 \alpha$ is _____. [JEE (Adv)-2018 (Paper-1)]
31. Consider the cube in the first octant with sides OP , OQ and OR of length 1, along the x-axis, y-axis and z-axis, respectively, where $O(0, 0, 0)$ is the origin. Let $S\left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}\right)$ be the centre of the cube and T be the

vertex of the cube opposite to the origin O such that S lies on the diagonal OT . If $\vec{p} = \vec{SP}$, $\vec{q} = \vec{SQ}$, $\vec{r} = \vec{SR}$ and $\vec{t} = \vec{ST}$, then the value of $|(\vec{p} \times \vec{q}) \times (\vec{r} \times \vec{t})|$ is _____. [JEE (Adv)-2018 (Paper-2)]

32. Three lines are given by

$$\vec{r} = \lambda \hat{i}, \lambda \in \mathbb{R}$$

$$\vec{r} = \mu(\hat{i} + \hat{j}), \mu \in \mathbb{R} \text{ and}$$

$$\vec{r} = \nu(\hat{i} + \hat{j} + \hat{k}), \nu \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Let the lines cut the plane $x + y + z = 1$ at the points A , B and C respectively. If the area of the triangle ABC is Δ then the value of $(6\Delta)^2$ equals _____. [JEE (Adv)-2019 (Paper-1)]

33. Let $\vec{a} = 2\hat{i} + \hat{j} - \hat{k}$ and $\vec{b} = \hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + \hat{k}$ be two vectors. Consider a vector $\vec{c} = \alpha\vec{a} + \beta\vec{b}$, $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{R}$. If the projection of $\vec{c}$ on the vector $(\vec{a} + \vec{b})$ is $3\sqrt{2}$, then the minimum value of $(\vec{c} - (\vec{a} \times \vec{b})) \cdot \vec{c}$ equals _____. [JEE (Adv)-2019 (Paper-2)]

34. In a triangle PQR , let $\vec{a} = \vec{QR}$, $\vec{b} = \vec{RP}$ and $\vec{c} = \vec{PQ}$. If

$$|\vec{a}| = 3, |\vec{b}| = 4 \text{ and } \frac{\vec{a} \cdot (\vec{c} - \vec{b})}{\vec{c} \cdot (\vec{a} - \vec{b})} = \frac{|\vec{a}|}{|\vec{a}| + |\vec{b}|}$$

then the value of $|\vec{a} \times \vec{b}|^2$ is _____ [JEE (Adv)-2020 (Paper-1)]

35. Let $\vec{u}, \vec{v}$ and $\vec{w}$ be vectors in three-dimensional space, where $\vec{u}$ and $\vec{v}$ are unit vectors which are not perpendicular to each other and
 $\vec{u} \cdot \vec{w} = 1, \quad \vec{v} \cdot \vec{w} = 1, \quad \vec{w} \cdot \vec{w} = 4$

If the volume of the parallelepiped, whose adjacent sides are represented by the vectors $\vec{u}, \vec{v}$ and $\vec{w}$, is $\sqrt{2}$, then the value of $|3\vec{u} + 5\vec{v}|$ is _____. [JEE (Adv)-2021 (Paper-1)]

